

Altamirano Builders App

User Guide

A step-by-step guide to uploading, reviewing, and reporting on your TIO increment files.

What This App Does

This app takes the place of the manual work you've been doing in Excel every time the state sends over an updated TIO increment file. Instead of copying data by hand and comparing files line by line, the app does it for you.

Here's what it handles automatically:

- Reads the state's file and builds your All Data, Sum Data, and Report tabs — the same reports you used to build by hand.
- Compares a newly uploaded file against what you already had, and shows you exactly what's new, removed, or changed.
- Keeps track of which items you've marked Done, and remembers that even when a new file comes in.
- Lets you export a clean, ready-to-use Excel file at any time.

Getting Started

Opening the App

Double-click the app's icon to open it. The first time you open it, your computer may show a security warning since this is a new program — this is normal and covered in the Setup Guide.

Choosing Where Your Data Is Stored

The very first time you open the app, it will ask you where you'd like it to store your projects and files. A sensible default location is already filled in — you can just accept it, or click Browse to pick somewhere else (for example, a folder that's backed up or synced elsewhere). You'll only see this the first time; after that, the app remembers your choice.

If you ever want to change this later, open the Settings menu at the top of the window and choose Change Data Location. Choosing a new folder will automatically move all of your existing projects and files there — nothing is lost, and you don't need to move anything yourself.

The Main Screen

At the top of the app, you'll see:

- A menu button (☰) on the far left — see The Menu Button below.
- Your company logo and the word “Project” with a dropdown menu.
- Add, Update, and Delete buttons, for managing your list of projects.

Below that, once you select a project, you'll see the list of increments for that project.

The Menu Button

Click the ☰ icon in the top-left corner to open the menu. It has four options:

- About — shows which version of the app you're running, along with a short summary of what's included in that version.
- Help — opens this User Guide.
- Check for Updates — checks whether a newer version of the app is available. If one is, you'll see a Download button that takes you to the download page in your browser; if you're already on the latest version, it'll simply let you know. If the check can't complete (for example, no internet connection), it fails quietly rather than showing an alarming error — just try again later.
- Exit — closes the app.

Creating a New Project

1. Click Add next to the Project dropdown.
2. Enter the Project Name and the Home Folder (where you'd like the app to look for or store related files).
3. Click Submit.

Your new project will now appear in the dropdown at the top.

Uploading a File

There's just one button for this: Upload File. Select your project from the dropdown, click Upload File, and choose the Excel file the state sent you (.xlsm or .xlsx).

You don't need to tell the app whether this is a brand-new increment or an update to one you already have — it figures that out on its own by reading the increment's name directly from the file.

What Happens Automatically

- New increment: if the name in the file doesn't match anything already in the project, the app creates a new increment. Since there's nothing to compare it to yet, it simply confirms the upload and takes you straight to the data view.
- Update to an existing increment: if the name matches one you already have, the app treats this as an update and shows you the review screen (below) before anything is saved.

- Not sure: if the name looks very similar to one you already have but isn't an exact match (for example, a small spelling or punctuation difference from the state), the app will ask you directly: is this an update to the existing one, or a new increment? Just pick whichever is correct.

Note

Every file you upload is saved automatically and never overwritten. Older versions are always kept, so nothing is ever lost.

Understanding the Report Tabs

Once a file is loaded, you'll see three tabs at the top of the data view:

- All Data — every item from the state's file, laid out in one flat table.
- Sum Data — the same items, showing which stages are marked Done or Open, along with a percent-complete column for each item.
- Report — a summary, grouped by agency, with a grand total at the bottom.

These are the same three reports you used to build by hand — the app just builds them for you, every time, from whatever file you upload.

All Data and Sum Data each end with a bold totals row, summarizing every column above it — the same convention your original spreadsheets have used.

Viewing a Previous Version

Every version you've ever uploaded for an increment is saved, and you can look back at any of them. Next to the increment title in the data view, there's a dropdown listing every version by number and date (for example, v3 (2026-07-06), v2 (2026-07-05), v1 (2026-07-03)) — it opens showing the latest version by default.

Select a different version from the dropdown to see exactly what that version's data looked like at the time. If you export while looking at an older version, the exported file reflects that version, not the latest one — its file name will show which version it came from.

Good to know

Done/Open marks always reflect your current progress, not what was marked at the time of that older version. If you're looking at anything other than the latest version, a small banner reminds you of this.

Marking Items as Done

In the All Data tab, each item shows its required stages, marked green (Done) or red (Open). Click directly on a stage to toggle it between the two.

There's no separate Save button — your click is saved right away.

The Sum Data tab shows this same status for reference, displayed as the words “Done” or “Open” with the same green or red background — this view is read-only; use All Data to actually change a status.

Reviewing an Update

When Upload File detects that a file is an update to an increment you already have, this is where the app does its most valuable work.

The Review Screen

Before anything is saved, you'll see a screen comparing your new file to what you had before. It's broken into a few sections:

- New Items — things that appear in the new file but weren't in the old one.
- Removed Items — things that were in the old file but are missing from the new one.
- Column Issues — any sign that the state changed the structure of the file itself (a renamed or missing column, for example).
- Values Changed — items that existed in both files, but where a requirement or test count changed.

If a section is empty, it simply won't be shown — you'll only see what's actually relevant.

If any part of the Report total will change as a result of the update, you'll see a note showing the before and after totals, so you know the impact before you commit to anything.

Confirm or Discard

- Confirm & Update — saves the new file as the current version. You'll be asked to confirm once more, since this replaces your working data. Any Done marks you've already made are kept for items that didn't change.
- Cancel/Discard — backs out with no changes made. Safe to click any time, no second confirmation needed.

Why this matters

This screen exists so a new file from the state can never quietly change your data without you seeing it first. Nothing is saved until you explicitly confirm it.

Exporting to Excel

4. From the data view, click Export to Excel.
5. Choose where to save the file and what to name it (the app will suggest a sensible name based on the project and increment).
6. The exported file includes all three tabs — All Data, Sum Data, and Report — formatted and ready to send or print.

Where Your Files Are Kept

The app automatically keeps two different things in two different places:

- Reports you export — wherever you chose to save them when you clicked Export to Excel. These are yours to move, send, or print freely.
- Everything else (your projects, uploaded files, and progress) — saved automatically in a folder called AltamiranoBuildersAppData, tucked inside your user folder. You don't need to do anything with this folder yourself — the app manages it for you.

You shouldn't normally need to open that folder. It's mainly useful to know about if you ever want to back up your data, or if you're asked to check something for troubleshooting — see the Setup Guide for exactly where to find it.

Deleting a Project

Click Delete next to the Project dropdown, and confirm when asked. The project will disappear from your list.

Good to know

Deleting a project doesn't erase it permanently — it's moved to a hidden safety location in case it was a mistake. If you ever need something back after deleting it, don't try to recreate it from scratch — ask for help recovering it first.

Deleting an Increment

If you need to remove a single increment (for example, one created by mistake) without deleting the whole project, click Delete on that increment's row in the increment list, and confirm when asked. Only that increment is removed — the rest of the project is untouched.

Good to know

Just like deleting a project, this isn't permanent — the increment is moved to a hidden safety location rather than erased. Ask for help recovering it if you need something back.

Tips & Troubleshooting

- Windows security warning on first run: click “More info,” then “Run anyway.” This is normal for new, unsigned software and only appears the first time.
- Large files can take several seconds to load — you'll see a loading message. This is expected and doesn't mean the app has frozen.
- If something looks wrong after an update, you can always check the review screen's summary again before confirming, or discard the update and try re-uploading the file.